Mark Cheli

Director, Product Operations & Strategy · Onshape (PTC)

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I run Product Operations & Strategy for Onshape, the cloud-native CAD platform that is PTC's fastest-growing business. The team makes sure the people deciding what the product does next have what they need to decide well: the analysis, the strategy work, the information moving through the org. Then it keeps the plan honest. AI is a big part of the job and of how I work. At Onshape I run the tooling, guidelines and budget for Claude and the other AI tools across the whole company, not just R&D, and I spend a lot of my own time building with agents. I came up through PTC as a software engineer, intern to director across a lot of different roles and organizations, and I still write code for whatever needs it, product features included. That's the common thread: I build things. Software mostly, but also welding, 3D printing, and three old trucks. This site runs on a server in my basement, next to the apps I've built for myself.

EXPERIENCE

Director, Product Operations & Strategy — Jan 2022 – present

PTC — Onshape · Boston, MA

Product Operations & Strategy supports the people who decide what Onshape does next: the strategy and analysis behind the decisions, the planning cycle that turns them into work, the analytics that say how it's going, and the programs that cut across every team. I'm responsible for the team and for a good share of its output.

- AI at Onshape: how the organization adopts it. The tooling, guidelines, governance and budget for Claude and other AI tools across the company, and what it changes about how software gets built.
- Strategy and analysis for product decisions, the planning cycle, and the product analytics and data warehouse behind both.
- The programs that cut across every team, localization and legal among them, and product management for the tools the org runs on.
- Software engineering when something needs building, product features and the tooling around them alike. Thirteen years at PTC from intern to director, across engineering, product and operations roles.
- 2022: interim head of business operations for the Onshape business unit.

Director, Education Product — Feb 2021 – Jan 2022

PTC · Boston, MA

Product for PTC's Education group: services, support, partnerships, community and marketing for the academic programs around Onshape, Creo and ThingWorx.

Senior Manager, Education Experience Jan 2020 – Feb 2021
PTC · Boston, MA

The education customer experience after PTC acquired Onshape.

Senior Manager, Customer Training Technology & Research
Jan 2019 – Jan 2020
PTC · Boston, MA

Product for PTC's customer training: eLearning, virtual instructor-led training and in-product help. A 40-person group across the US and Pune.

Senior Software Development Manager, PTC University EdTech R&D
May 2018 – Jan 2019
PTC · Needham, MA

Engineering management for PTC's learning platforms: 35 engineers in three teams.

Technology Lead, Academic & Customer Training Products
Apr 2017 – May 2018
PTC · Needham, MA

Lead engineer and product manager for IoTU.com and the academic product line, with teams in the US and India.

Senior Full-Stack Software Engineer Oct 2016 – Apr 2017
PTC · Needham, MA

Led the academic software development group. IoT education products on the MEAN stack and ThingWorx.

Academic Software Engineer May 2013 – Oct 2016
PTC · Needham, MA

Started as a student intern, then full-time. Curriculum, demos and applications for Creo, Windchill, Mathcad and ThingWorx.

Web Developer Dec 2012 – Dec 2014
Freelance

Small-business websites: HTML/CSS, PHP/MySQL, WordPress.

Assistant Program Facilitator Dec 2011 – May 2013
Christa McAuliffe Center / Challenger Learning Center, Framingham State University

Planetarium shows and simulated space missions for middle-school groups, plus the center's IT.

EDUCATION

B.S., Business & Information Technology 2011 – 2015
Framingham State University · Summa Cum Laude, GPA 3.94

CERTIFICATES

- Certified Onshape Associate · Onshape · 2021-01

SKILLS

Product and strategy	Product operations · Strategy and analysis · Planning · Product analytics · Product management · Localization · Legal and terms of use
Data	SQL · AWS Redshift · dbt · Prefect · Streamlit · Looker
Building	Python (Flask, FastAPI) · TypeScript (Vue, Nuxt) · PostgreSQL · Docker · GitHub Actions · Linux · Onshape
AI	AI adoption and governance · Claude and Claude Code · GitHub Copilot · MCP servers · Agentic coding setups · AI tooling budgets

INTERESTS

Making things	3D printing · Welding · Woodworking · Onshape CAD
Old trucks	1991 Honda Acty · 1997 GMC Suburban · 1996 Mazda B4000
Homelab and self-hosting	Dell PowerEdge R630 · Docker · Observability
Sim racing and flight sim	iRacing · DCS · RigReady
Outdoors	Backpacking · Car camping · Ham radio

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